

Redmi Watch 5 Active

A budget-friendly daily companion

One of the early movers in the wearables space, Xiaomi, with its Mi Band and Watch series, has been doing some great work over the years in the wearables space. Their products are well built and perform decently well, and the user experience is also one of the best in their price range with the release of every product. Be it their Mi band series of smart-bands or their Redmi Watch series of smartwatches, the brand has proven time and again that they are capable of being the budget king. So, when the Redmi Watch 5 Active came to the Digit Test Centre, my expectations were riding high. I set out to answer one of the most pertinent questions – will the Redmi Watch 5 Active dethrone our go-to recommendation in the sub-₹3,000 in the price range, its predecessor, the Redmi Watch 3 Active?

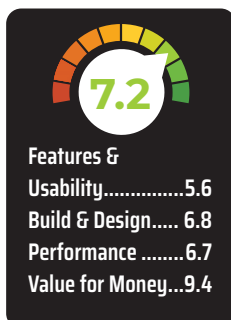
Well, I put the watch through the churner of our test process and here's what I found out –

BUILD AND DESIGN

In terms of build and design, Xiaomi has gone with a massy and conservative design language on the Redmi Watch 5 Active. You have a rectangular watch face with rounded corners in a metallic casing, supported by a plastic back, which houses the sensor window and a silicon strap that comes attached out of the box. Nothing that stands out, everything that a regular user would need.

The metal case adds a nice touch of confidence when it comes to the overall quality and feel of the watch. There is no specific mention of certification for the front crystal of the watch protecting the screen, but it is made of glass. And, as you know, glass

₹2,799



is glass, and it will scratch and break. Nevertheless, in my time of use, the watch did not pick up any major scratches or scuffs. No complaints here.

The strap also did not cause any irritation on my skin, and given that it has been made out of the widely adopted silicon

material, it should be fine for most users, too. However, if you are someone who is susceptible to irritation when exposed to silicon, then you can swap the existing one for third-party straps that are plenty on online marketplaces. The only button on the side of the watch is also metallic with a nice polished edge, helping it stand out, and its overall feel and tactility were great in day-to-day use. It was responsive and registered inputs flawlessly.

In day-to-day use, there are no complaints either. The Redmi Watch 5 Active is lightweight, and given its solid build, you will have no worries rocking it daily. The watch is rated IPX8, which means you can expose it to water for longer than many other

options available. However, given that there is no official dust protection, you will need to be careful on your trail runs and in dusty environments.

DISPLAY

The display of the Redmi Watch 5 Active is a standard LCD display with a 320 x 385 pixel resolution. It is responsive and rarely misses any touches, even when slightly wet, and it does get fairly bright, too. It is one of the few displays that I have tested that reaches the exact claimed number by the brand when it comes to peak brightness.

Xiaomi claims that the display of the Redmi Watch 5 Active can go up to 500 nits, and in my testing, I recorded its peak brightness to be 497 nits, which is amazing! In bright daylight, the text on the display is fairly legible, and the 2-inch size means that it fits enough information from the notifications to be fairly useful. One gripe that I have here, with the display of the watch is the uneven bezel around the main display.

The bezel, to start with, is thick all around. But when you get to the bottom edge of the screen, you get an even thicker bezel, which was a big turn-off for me. From the time I took the watch out of the box, I could see the choker of a display bezel on the watch, and it kept on irking me. You can work around it by choosing a darker watch face, which Xiaomi has defaulted to out of the box, but you will be reminded of its chunkiness whenever you are turning on the flashlight.

Apart from that, solid work here as well by Xiaomi!

FEATURES AND USABILITY

In terms of features and usability, Xiaomi has again hit the ball out of the park for me with the Redmi Watch 5 Active. You get all you can ask for with the Redmi Watch 5 Active. Calling from the device, yes! Auto vitals tracking, yes! Great UI and, hence, a great user experience, yes! Customisability, yes!

I will not go into the depth of what is being claimed here by the